

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

CHILDHOOD

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

1 ... (poem : childhood)

2 ... Poem Explanation

3 ...

4 ...

Childhood → Marcus Natten.



When did my childhood go? →

Was it the day I ^{stopped} ceased to be eleven,

Was it the time I ^{understood} realised that Hell and Heaven,

Could not be found in Geography,

And therefore could not be,

Was that the day!

Ceased: Stopped

Realised: Understood

Heaven/Hell: Religious places;
used symbolically for belief

Geography: Earth science; here,
used to contrast imagination vs
reality

Summary:

The poet wonders when exactly his childhood ended. He questions whether it was when he turned twelve or when he came to understand that Heaven and Hell are not real physical places that one can locate on a map. This realization about religious myths symbolizes a loss of innocence and intellectual maturity.

QUESTION



According to the poet, when might childhood have ended?

- 1 When he started school
- 2 When he *stopped* ceased eleven
- 3 When he turned sixteen
- 4 Ceased

QUESTION

What realization about Heaven and Hell does the poet mention?

- 1 They cannot be located in Geography ~~✗~~
- 2 They exist in the sky and the earth
- 3 They are myths found in fairy tales
- 4 They are present in the soul

QUESTION



What is the tone of this stanza?

- 1 Angry
- 2 Curious and reflective ~~✗~~
- 3 Excited
- 4 Boring

Childhood



When did my childhood go?

Was it the time I ^{onward} realised that adults were not
all they seemed to be,

^{adults}
They talked of love and preached of love,

But did not act so lovingly,

Was that the day!

Realised: Became aware

Preached: Advised or spoke
morally

Lovingly: In a caring and kind
way

Seemed: Appeared to be, but
not necessarily true

Summary:

The poet wonders when exactly his childhood ended. He questions whether it was when he turned twelve or when he came to understand that Heaven and Hell are not real physical places that one can locate on a map. This realization about religious myths symbolizes a loss of innocence and intellectual maturity.

QUESTION



What does the poet realize about adults?

- 1 They are always honest
- 2 They live in dreams
- 3 They never speak of love
- 4 They don't practice what they preach

QUESTION



What is the main idea of this stanza?

- 1 Adults are friendly
- 2 Adults are dishonest and hypocritical ✖
- 3 Adults are loving
- 4 Adults are always helpful

QUESTION



Which emotion is reflected in this stanza?

- 1** Disappointment ~~✗~~
- 2** Fear
- 3** Joy
- 4** Hope

Childhood



When did my childhood go?
Was it when I found my mind was really mine,
To use whichever way I choose,
Producing thoughts that were not those of other people
But my own, and mine alone
Was that the day!

Whichever: Any one from many

Choose: Select

Producing: Creating

Alone: Without anyone else

Mine: Belonging to me

Summary:

The poet reflects on a significant moment when he discovered that he had his own independent thoughts. He no longer followed ideas blindly but started thinking for himself. This mental independence marks a major step in personal and intellectual growth, another point where childhood ends.

QUESTION



What is the poet referring to in this stanza?

- 1 Mental illness
 - 2 Childish behavior
 - 3 Childish behavior
 - 4 Intellectual freedom
-
- A handwritten yellow bracket groups options 2 and 3. A yellow checkmark is next to option 4.

QUESTION



What does "my mind was really mine" mean?

- 1 He became selfish
- 2 He became mentally ill
- ~~3 He realized he had independent thinking~~
- 4 He lost his mind

QUESTION



What realization does the poet come to in this stanza?

- 1** His friends have changed
- 2** He needs help from adults
- 3** He is no longer in school
- 4**  His thoughts are unique and his own

Childhood



Where did my childhood go?
It went to some forgotten place,
That's hidden in an infant's face,
That's all I know.

Forgotten: Not remembered
Hidden: Kept out of sight
Infant: A very young child
That's all I know: Shows acceptance and resignation

Summary:

In this final stanza, the poet acknowledges that childhood is gone forever. He cannot point out the exact moment it disappeared. All he knows is that it exists now only in the face of a young child, symbolizing innocence, wonder, and purity. It's a wistful acceptance of the passage of time.

QUESTION



Where does the poet say childhood is hidden?

- 1 In dreams
- 2 In an infant's face 
- 3 In the sky
- 4 In his school

QUESTION



What does “infant’s face” symbolize?

- 1 Innocence and purity 
- 2 Age and maturity
- 3 Anger and frustration
- 4 Hope and power

QUESTION



What is the tone of the final stanza?

- 1 Angry
- 2 Confused and nostalgic ✕
- 3 Hopeful
- 4 Energetic

Childhood



Poetic Device	Example from Poem	Explanation/Effect
Rhetorical Question	“When did my childhood go?” “Was that the day!”	Used repeatedly in all stanzas to reflect the poet's self-questioning and introspection. It adds a philosophical tone.
Alliteration	“ <u>m</u> ind was <u>m</u> ine”, “ <u>f</u> ace... <u>f</u> orgotten” “talked of love and preached of love”	The repetition of consonant sounds at the beginning of nearby words enhances rhythm and musicality.

Childhood



Poetic Device	Example from Poem	Explanation/Effect
Enjambment	Entire poem flows line to line without full stops	Creates a smooth, thoughtful flow of ideas without abrupt breaks, reflecting the continuous process of growing up.
Irony	“They talked of love and preached of love, but did not act so lovingly”.	Highlights the gap between adult words and actions, showing the poet's disillusionment.
Symbolism	“Heaven and Hell”, “infant's face”	Heaven and Hell represent beliefs and innocence; an infant's face symbolizes purity, lost childhood.

Childhood



Poetic Device	Example from Poem	Explanation/Effect
Metaphor	“Hidden in an infant’s face”	Compares childhood to something buried or preserved in a baby's face, giving a visual image of innocence.
Repetition	“Was that the day!” “mine... mine alone”	Emphasizes important ideas such as loss of childhood and self-identity. Creates a musical effect.

Childhood



Poetic Device	Example from Poem	Explanation/Effect
Contrast	Adult's words vs actions, belief vs reality	Highlights the gap between innocence and maturity, leading to emotional and intellectual growth.
Imagery	"hidden in an infant's face"	Evokes visual images and emotions, helping readers connect to the idea of lost innocence.

QUESTION



Identify the stanza that talks of each of the following:

- (a) Individuality
- (b) Rationalism
- (c) Hypocrisy

ANSWER:

(a) Individuality – Stanza 3

This stanza reflects the poet's realization that he has his own thoughts and opinions, different from others

(b) Rationalism – Stanza 1

The poet begins to question the existence of heaven and hell, which reflects logical thinking or rationalism.

(c) Hypocrisy – Stanza 2

The poet sees that adults say one thing and do another, showing their double standards or hypocrisy.

QUESTION

What according to the poem is involved in the process of growing up?

ANSWER:

According to the poem, growing up involves developing the ability to think independently, question accepted beliefs, recognize the hypocrisy of adults, and become aware of one's own individuality.

QUESTION

What is the poet's feeling towards childhood?

ANSWER:

The poet feels that childhood is a precious and innocent stage of life. He reflects on its loss with a sense of nostalgia and wonders where it disappeared—whether it was lost physically or simply left behind in time.

QUESTION



Which do you think are the most poetic lines? Why?

ANSWER:

The lines “It went to some forgotten place,/That’s hidden in an infant’s face” are the most poetic.

These lines beautifully express the mystery and innocence of childhood, suggesting that while childhood is lost to the poet, it still exists in the face of a young child, hidden and pure.

Thank
You